LAF YOMI

Bekhorot 31 · 2026-10-19

The Torah forbids switching your maaser behemah for a nicer animal ([redacted]). Bornstein notes the would-be schemer's plan backfires: Masechet Temurah rules that both animals become holy.

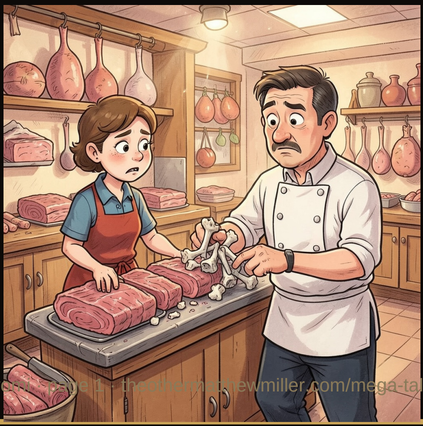
""Let's say you go ahead and you switch — oh, temurah? Well, [redacted], [redacted] — the joke's on you!""

— Rabbi Sruly Bornstein

Chazal permitted selling blemished hekdesh animals in the butcher shop, weighed on a scale — normally disrespectful — so buyers would pay top dollar and hekdesh wouldn't lose money. Bornstein explains the economics with modern investment theory.

""You want to sell it to the guy that overpays, right? That's who you're looking for when you're a seller. That's always the greater fool theory, right? That's always the [redacted].""

— Rabbi Sruly Bornstein



Havla'ah (bundling a sale) only works when it's not obvious. A good havla'ah: the esrog seller throws in an esrog with your lulav. A bad one: bundling worthless bones with meat and charging full price.

""What are all the things you threw in the garbage? That's what he wants — all

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Rav Idi, Rav Sheshes's attendant, heard his master's brilliant teretz and repeated it in the beis medrash without giving credit. Rav Sheshes heard about it and was not pleased.

""The person that bit me — Rashi says ■■■■■ ■■■■■ — ■■■■■■ ■■■■■: he should be bitten by a scorpion.""

— Rabbi Sruly Bornstein (quoting the Gemara)

Rava and Rav Yosef — who famously always see the world differently — were both invited to visit Rav Huna bar Chiya with 400 pairs of rabbis. Rava went; Rav Yosef didn't. Bornstein imagines their Yiddish deliberation.

""Pun intended for this ■■■■ — dude, they were both going: ■■■ ■■■? ■■■ ■■■ ■■■■. But it's like unbelievable. ■■ ■■■■ ■■ ■■■, ■■■ ■■■.""

— Rabbi Sruly Bornstein

Rava and Rav Yosef learned Rav Huna bar Chiya had become a ■■■■ ■■■ — a tax collector, not a ■■■■ ■■■■ — so they refused to visit him, sending word: keep your position and your dignity, but lose our company.

""You want that job, you can have that job — ■■■■■■■■■■■■ — but I'm